

Visit Bucket Methodology

Pre-filter applied to all visits: dropped any visit with fewer than 2 user actions to remove bots and accidental landings. The monthly view further excludes weekends.

Each visit is assigned to exactly one category using a first-match precedence rule. Categories are checked in order — once a visit matches, it stops. Summaries below are sorted by share of total; the detailed definitions that follow are in precedence order.

April 15, 2026

Category	Visits	%
Search User	388,755	66.1%
Independent	51,625	8.8%
CAD Designer	39,075	6.6%
Centralized Buyer	32,427	5.5%
Account Curious	28,765	4.9%
Shared Login	28,715	4.9%
Multi-Platform	15,236	2.6%
Office Clerk	3,840	0.7%
Total	588,437	100.0%

April 1 – 30, 2026, excluding weekends

Category	Visits	%	Logged in?
Search User	6,000,254	59.08%	N
Independent	936,634	9.22%	Y
CAD Designer	819,974	8.07%	N
Multi-Platform	769,230	7.57%	Y
Account Curious	573,795	5.65%	Y
Centralized Buyer	521,804	5.14%	Y
Shared Login	457,079	4.50%	Y
Office Clerk	77,639	0.76%	Y
Total	10,156,409	100.0%	

Category Definitions (in Precedence Order)

1. Office Clerk

The office person who handles paperwork on behalf of orderers. They never place orders themselves; they download invoices, packing slips, material certificates, and check tracking numbers for orders that other people in their company placed.

How we identified them: the visit had post-order success activity (any document download, tracking lookup, or cert save) AND did not place an order today.

Why first: downloading order documents is a highly specific behavior — if you see it, this is what they came for.

2. CAD Designer

The engineer or product designer who comes to McMaster to grab CAD models for parts they're designing into a product. They may never order through McMaster.

How we identified them: the visit had at least one successful CAD download AND did not place an order today.

Why second: saving CAD is a specific behavioral signal of intent. Wins over customer-profile labels because the persona is defined by behavior, not customer state.

3. Search User

The person who uses McMaster as a reference catalog to browse, copy part numbers, print pages, or forward info to a colleague. They are not logged in at the time of visit.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor_id is either missing entirely (never touched the order pad), or has no contact record attached (touched the order pad but never ordered).

Why third: once we've ruled out the specific behavior buckets, anyone without a customer record is functionally a search user.

4. Account Curious

The person who created a McMaster login but has never placed an order and is not linked to a CMF.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor has at least one contact record, but that contact has zero ship-to locations on file, AND the visit didn't place an order today.

Why fourth: sits between Search and the real-customer buckets — they're more than a search user (they have a login) but not yet a real customer (no ship-to).

5. Multi-Platform User

The same person showing up across multiple McMaster platforms — mcmaster.com, the iPhone app, mobile web, punchout, etc.

How we identified them: the visitor_id appeared on 2 or more distinct platforms within the analysis window.

Why fifth: this is a person-level behavior pattern, weaker than visit-level behavior. Sits above the customer-profile buckets because cross-platform use is more interesting than profile alone.

6. Shared Login

Multiple people at the same company share a single McMaster login. They might each place their own orders but use the same account credentials and shared order pad.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor_id is linked to 2 or more distinct contact records — meaning multiple real people have ordered under the same login. This is exactly how the data warehouse encodes shared accounts.

Why sixth: customer-profile signal, deferred behind visit-level and person-level behaviors above.

7. Centralized Buyer

One person who places orders for many ship-to locations.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor is linked to exactly 1 contact record (one login, not shared), and that contact has shipped to 2 or more distinct locations historically.

Why seventh: customer-profile signal, requires single-login plus multi-location.

8. Independent / Individual User

One person with their own McMaster login, ordering parts to one location. This is the persona that our website is optimized for.

How we identified them: the visit's visitor has exactly 1 contact and 1 ship-to location, OR the visit didn't match any earlier bucket. Includes a small group of first-time orderers whose ship-to record hasn't been fully built yet.

Why last: by design, this is the catch-all for normal-customer visits.